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FREE GUIDE

The Arizona Homeowner's Maintenance Calendar

A seasonal maintenance guide for Arizona homes.

Protect your investment with the right care at the right time.

Why Maintenance Matters

Arizona's climate, with scorching summers, monsoon storms, and constant dust, puts unique demands on a home. Staying on top of regular maintenance protects your investment and helps you avoid expensive emergency repairs.

This calendar is organized by season. Most tasks take an afternoon or less, and the ones that don't are worth hiring a professional for. Follow your equipment manufacturers' guidance and your own contractors' advice for specifics.

Spring (March to May)

Spring is your window to prepare for the Arizona summer. Focus on your cooling system, exterior, and landscaping.

HVAC

- [ ] Schedule a professional AC tune-up and inspection before the real heat arrives. Good HVAC companies book up fast in late spring.
- [ ] Replace air filters. Dust means they need attention more often than in many parts of the country.
- [ ] Clean the outdoor condenser unit: remove debris and rinse the coils gently with a hose.
- [ ] Check that all vents are open and unobstructed.
- [ ] If you have a smart thermostat, set up its summer schedule.

Exterior

- [ ] Inspect the roof for cracked or missing tiles, common after winter windstorms.
- [ ] Check exterior caulking around windows and doors. The sun breaks it down quickly.
- [ ] Inspect stucco for cracks. Hairline cracks from heat expansion are common.
- [ ] Clean out gutters if your home has them.
- [ ] Power wash the driveway, sidewalks, and patio.

Landscaping

- [ ] Adjust irrigation timers for rising temperatures.
- [ ] Trim trees and bushes away from the house and roof.
- [ ] Look for termite activity and schedule an annual termite inspection.
- [ ] Treat weeds in gravel and rock areas.

Pool (If Applicable)

- [ ] Schedule a pool equipment inspection and startup service.
- [ ] Check the pool fence and gate to make sure they close and latch properly. This is a key safety feature.
- [ ] Clean the tile line and check water chemistry.

Summer (June to August)

Summer means extreme heat and monsoon storms. Keep your AC running and protect against storm damage.

Monsoon Prep

- [ ] Clear yard drains and any drainage paths around your home.
- [ ] Trim trees near your roof and power lines. Monsoon winds snap branches.
- [ ] Secure or store loose patio furniture, umbrellas, and decorations before storms.
- [ ] Check your garage door seal. Dust and water get in during dust storms.
- [ ] Test your sump pump if you have one.
- [ ] Know where your main water shut-off is.
- [ ] Check for water intrusion after every major storm: ceilings, windows, and the garage.

Interior

- [ ] Check AC filters more often during peak summer, when dust and pollen are intense.
- [ ] Make sure the AC drain line is clear. A clogged drain line is a common cause of summer AC trouble.
- [ ] Keep an eye on your electric bill. A sudden spike can signal an AC problem.
- [ ] Run ceiling fans counterclockwise (as viewed from below) to push air down.

Pool

- [ ] Clean skimmer baskets often. Monsoon debris clogs them fast.
- [ ] Check water chemistry regularly. Intense sun uses up chlorine quickly.
- [ ] Make sure pool equipment is running properly.

> **Brian's Tip:** If your AC fails in July, it can take days to get a technician during peak season. That spring tune-up is worth it. If your system is getting old, start planning for replacement before it quits in August.

Fall (September to November)

Fall is the most comfortable season here and a great time for outdoor projects and winter preparation.

HVAC

- [ ] Test your heating system before you need it.
- [ ] Replace air filters.
- [ ] Consider duct cleaning if it's been several years. Dust accumulates inside ducts.

Exterior

- [ ] Inspect the roof again after monsoon season for loose tiles, debris damage, or leaks.
- [ ] Touch up exterior paint where sun damage is visible.
- [ ] Check the irrigation system for leaks or broken heads.
- [ ] Clean and store monsoon prep supplies.

Interior

- [ ] Check smoke and CO detectors and replace batteries.
- [ ] Test garage door safety sensors and lubricate moving parts.
- [ ] Check the water heater for sediment buildup. Flushing annually is common practice with hard water.
- [ ] Inspect under sinks for leaks.
- [ ] Check caulking around showers and tubs.

Winter (December to February)

Arizona winters are mild, but freezing temperatures can happen overnight. A few precautions go a long way.

- [ ] Protect outdoor pipes and hose bibs on nights that dip to freezing.
- [ ] Disconnect and drain garden hoses.
- [ ] Adjust irrigation timers for cooler weather. Overwatering in winter hurts desert plants.
- [ ] Service your fireplace or fire pit before heavy use.
- [ ] Check weather stripping on exterior doors. Cold air and dust both sneak through gaps.
- [ ] Clean the dryer vent. A clogged vent is a fire hazard, so do this annually.
- [ ] Schedule your annual termite inspection if it's due.
- [ ] Deep clean the interior to start the new year fresh.

Annual Professional Services to Schedule

Service	When
AC tune-up	Spring, before summer
Termite inspection	Spring or fall
Roof inspection	Fall, after monsoon season
Pool service startup	Spring
Water heater flush	Fall
Dryer vent cleaning	Winter
Deep house cleaning	Spring or winter

Costs vary by provider and change over time, so get current quotes before you schedule.

Need a Contractor Recommendation?

Ask me. I'm happy to point you toward trusted local pros for any of the services above, whether or not we've worked together on a purchase.

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